



Extreme Environments



Extreme environments can be found all over planet Earth. An extreme environment is a place where it is difficult or impossible for humans to survive. But, there are some living things that can survive in such extreme places.

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Extreme environments might have very high temperatures or pressure, or be very acidic or alkaline, or extremely cold. An extreme environment can include polar continents, deserts, deep oceans, geothermal and volcanic vents, and even outer space.

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Let's look at some examples of extreme environments. The Arctic and the Antarctic are the two polar regions on Earth. The Arctic is home to arctic foxes, wolves, seals, whales and polar bears. These animals have adapted to the cold here.

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Antarctica is the coldest and windiest place on Earth. It is mostly covered in ice. Penguins can survive on the coast, and microscopic animals and insects live on the land. Seals, whales and dolphins live in the sea around the Antarctic. In Antarctica, people use technology to live in scientific research stations.

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Another example of an extreme environment is a desert. Deserts are dry, and they can be hot and cold. Some deserts are sandy and some deserts are rocky. With little water in deserts, animals and people have had to adapt.

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Why do people want to go to these extreme environments? Humans like to explore new frontiers. Ancient peoples explored harsh environments to find new places to live. People can explore to learn about the world.

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Scientists want to know why and how living organisms have adapted to extreme habitats. In extreme environments, we can discover new plant and animal species. We can also understand Earth's history, and issues like climate change through exploring extreme environments.

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